

Presenter Guide

Make & ActivePieces — VA Tutorial Video

Your talking points and screen cues for recording. Not for sharing with VAs.

How to Use This Guide

Each section has two parts: **WHAT TO SAY** (your talking points - read these loosely, not word for word) and **SHOW ON SCREEN** (what to have open or click at that moment). Work through them in order. Rough total recording time: **15-20 minutes**.

Before You Hit Record

- ✓ Have make.com open and logged in (free account)
- ✓ Have activepieces.com open in a second tab (free account)
- ✓ Have a Google Sheet open with a few rows of test data (Name | Status | Date columns)
- ✓ Close any other browser tabs - keep the screen clean
- ✓ Test your mic and check your recording software before starting

Segment 1 — Intro

Approx. 1-2 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Hey everyone - in this video I'm going to show you two free automation tools: Make and ActivePieces.
- These connect your Google apps together so they can take actions automatically without you clicking anything.
- Both are free to start. Both work with Gmail, Google Sheets, Google Forms, all of it.
- The big thing both of them do is if/else logic - which just means: if this condition is true, do this. Otherwise, do something different.
- I'll show you Make first, then ActivePieces. At the end I'll tell you which one to start with.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Show your desktop or a blank browser - nothing specific needed for the intro
- Optional: show the quick comparison card from the VA tutorial PDF on screen

Presenter tip: Keep the intro under 90 seconds. Don't over-explain before they've seen anything. Get to the demo fast.

Segment 2 — Make.com Overview

Approx. 2 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Make is a visual tool - you'll see a canvas, like a blank page, and you drag things called modules onto it.
- Each module is one app action. So "Watch Emails" is one module. "Send an Email" is another.
- When data moves through your modules, Make counts it as an operation. The free plan gives you 1,000 per month.
- Free plan also gives you 2 active scenarios. A scenario is just one complete automation.
- If/else in Make is called a Router - and it's free on every plan.
- There is an AI assistant that helps you build scenarios, but only on paid plans. I'll show you where it lives.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Show the Make dashboard (your scenario list)
- Point out the "Create a new scenario" button
- Open an existing scenario if you have one, or click Create to show the blank canvas
- Point to the + button in the center of the canvas

Remember: Free = 2 active scenarios, 1,000 ops/month. Core = \$9/month, unlimited scenarios, 1-min intervals.

Segment 3 — Make Live Demo

Approx. 5-6 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Let me build one live so you can see exactly how it works.
- I'll use Google Sheets as the trigger - when a new row appears, something happens.
- Then I'll add a Router to show you the if/else.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click "Create a new scenario"
- Click the + on the canvas - search Google Sheets - select "Watch Rows"
- Connect Google account (or select existing connection)
- Select your test spreadsheet and sheet tab - set max results to 5 - click OK

WHAT TO SAY

- So that's my trigger. Every time a new row appears, this scenario wakes up.
- Now I'll add a Router right after - this is the if/else.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click + after the Google Sheets module - search Router - select it
- Show the two route boxes that appear
- Click the wrench icon on Route 1 - show the filter panel
- Set condition: Status column | Equal to | Qualified - click OK

WHAT TO SAY

- Route 1 runs only when Status equals Qualified. I'll add a Gmail action here.
- Route 2 gets no filter - that means it catches everything else. The "else" branch.
- Let me add a different Gmail action on Route 2 so you can see both paths.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click + at end of Route 1 - Gmail - Send an Email - fill in To/Subject/Body - click OK
- Click + at end of Route 2 - Gmail - Send an Email - fill in different Subject - click OK

- Click "Run once" at the bottom left
- Show the execution result - point to which route ran and why
- Toggle the scenario ON at the bottom

Presenter tip: If the test run shows an error, the most common cause is the Google connection. Just click the module, reconnect Google, and run once again. Don't panic on camera - troubleshooting live is actually good content.

Segment 4 — Make Native AI Feature

Approx. 1 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Make has a built-in AI assistant that can suggest modules based on what you describe.
- It's only on paid plans - Core is \$9 a month.
- On the free plan you just search for modules manually, which is fine for learning.
- There's also a separate thing: you can add OpenAI or Anthropic as a module step inside any scenario to process text. But that uses your own API key - that's not part of Make's subscription.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- If you have a Core+ account: click + to add a module - show the "Describe what you need" field at the top of the search panel
- If you're on free: just show the regular search panel and note where the AI field would appear on paid
- Optional: show the OpenAI module in search results to show AI-as-a-step

You can skip: You can skip the AI demo entirely if you don't have a Core account. Just explain it verbally and move on.

Segment 5 — ActivePieces Overview

Approx. 1-2 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Now let's look at ActivePieces. Same idea as Make, different interface.
- Instead of a canvas, ActivePieces is a vertical flow - steps listed top to bottom. Easier to read.
- The free plan is more generous: unlimited flows, 1,000 tasks a month, no credit card.
- If/else is called a Branch here - and it's free.
- One thing Make has that ActivePieces doesn't: Make has an AI assistant to help build automations. ActivePieces does not. You build everything manually.
- You can add AI as a step - like an OpenAI piece - but you bring your own API key for that.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Switch to the ActivePieces tab in your browser
- Show the dashboard (flow list)
- Point to the "New Flow" button

Remember: Key difference from Make: unlimited flows on free (Make gives you 2). No AI builder, but easier interface for beginners.

Segment 6 — ActivePieces Live Demo

Approx. 4-5 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Same automation as before - Google Sheets trigger, then an if/else.
- Watch how much simpler the interface looks compared to Make.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click "New Flow" - name it - click Create
- Click "Select Trigger" - search Google Sheets - choose "New Row"
- Connect Google account - select your spreadsheet - select sheet tab - click Save

WHAT TO SAY

- That's my trigger. Now I'll add the if/else - which in ActivePieces is called a Branch.
- I just click the plus and search for Branch. It's under Core, not an app.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click + below the trigger - search Branch - select it
- Show the True and False paths that appear
- Click "Add condition" - select Status field - set Equals - type Qualified - click Save

WHAT TO SAY

- True path runs when Status is Qualified. False path runs for everything else.
- I'll add a Gmail step in each path.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click + inside True path - Gmail - Send Email - fill in fields - click Save
- Click + inside False path - Gmail - Send Email - different subject - click Save
- Click "Test Flow" at the top
- Show which path ran - point to the green/grey checkmarks on each step
- Click Publish

Presenter tip: The green checkmarks on steps after testing are great to point out - VAs can use these to debug their own flows and see exactly where something went wrong.

Watch out: Case sensitivity in Branch conditions. If the sheet has "Qualified" with a capital Q, the condition must also use capital Q. Mention this - it's the most common beginner mistake.

Segment 7 — Which Tool Should You Use?

Approx. 1 min

WHAT TO SAY

- So which one should you start with?

- If you're brand new to automations - start with ActivePieces. No credit card, unlimited flows, simpler to read.
- If you want to eventually build more complex flows with a lot of branches - learn Make.
- Both are free. You don't have to pick one forever. A lot of people use both.
- The big thing to know: Zapier - the most famous tool - locks if/else behind a \$49 a month plan. Make and ActivePieces give it to you free. So for VAs doing conditional automations, these two are the smarter choice.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Optional: show the comparison table from the VA PDF on screen
- Or just talk to camera - no screen needed for this segment

Segment 8 — Outro

Approx. 30-60 sec

WHAT TO SAY

- That's it. Make and ActivePieces, side by side.
- I've put together a step-by-step PDF guide for you in the community - it has all the exact steps we went through today plus common mistakes to avoid.
- Start with one of these tools, build one automation, and get comfortable with the if/else logic. Once you've done it once, it clicks fast.
- Drop any questions in the comments and I'll answer them.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Talk to camera for the outro - no screen needed
- Optional: show the PDF thumbnail or the community post where you'll share it

Quick Reference

Term	Make calls it	ActivePieces calls it
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One automation	Scenario	Flow
One app action	Module	Step / Piece
Data processed	Operation	Task
If/else logic	Router	Branch
Free monthly limit	1,000 ops, 2 scenarios	1,000 tasks, unlimited flows
If/else on free?	YES	YES
AI builder	Paid only (Core+)	No - manual only